

Linping Zhang

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MSc Banking and Digital Finance candidate at UCL with experience in credit-risk modelling, portfolio stress analysis and financial-statement analysis, combining finance fundamentals with quantitative and data-driven analysis.

EDUCATION

MSc Banking and Digital Finance — University College London (UCL) *Sep 2025 – Sep 2026 (expected)*
BSc Finance — Nanjing Agricultural University (NAU) *Sep 2021 – Jun 2025*
GPA: 90.42/100 (3.85/4.5) — Top 13% of cohort

RELEVANT RISK PROJECTS

- Transformer-Based Credit Default Prediction** — Group project — architecture design | *Finance & AI*
- Analysed an imbalanced credit-card default dataset of ~30,000 customers — including credit limits, repayment status and payment behaviour — and designed the architecture for a Transformer-based credit-default model, collaborating with teammates on tokenisation and training.
 - Benchmarked the model against a Bayesian-tuned Random Forest, achieving a 0.7814 test ROC-AUC with higher recall; evaluated model selection through the trade-off between missed defaults and false-positive review costs.
- Corporate Treasury Portfolio — Unilever (£500m)** — Group project | *Treasury & Fixed Income*
- Proposed portfolio structures for a £500m strategic liquidity reserve and contributed to the team's adopted four-bucket allocation framework; collected and cleaned Bloomberg yield/duration data and helped define duration, credit-rating, concentration and FX constraints.
 - Co-authored the portfolio methodology and analysis, and cross-checked the final allocation (4.05% expected yield, 0.65-year duration) against a teammate's stress-testing results, confirming compliance with treasury-policy constraints despite an estimated 1.16% valuation decline under a severe combined scenario.
- LSTM Equity Trading Strategy — Robustness Testing** — Independent project | *Financial Analytics & ML*
- Independently replicated and stress-tested an LSTM equity-return model across multiple market regimes, controlling for look-ahead bias and transaction costs; identified substantial out-of-sample regime sensitivity, with Sharpe falling from 0.89 (2005–15) to -0.42 (2015–23).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Audit Intern** — KPMG — Audit Department *Jan 2025*
- Cross-checked audit report figures against supporting financial data, verifying consistency across client records and audit documentation.
 - Conducted sample testing across two client engagements, reviewing ledgers, contracts, invoices and bank receipts to confirm transaction accuracy and completeness of evidence, and supported the preparation and review of financial statements.
- Equity Research Assistant** — Huachuang Securities — Consumer/Liquor Sector *Sep 2024 – Jan 2025*
- Researched global spirits markets across the US, Europe and Asia using PEST analysis, contributing to two industry analysis reports; independently analysed the fundamentals, market positioning and ownership structure of six listed companies, supporting ongoing coverage of 13 listed firms.
 - Monitored sales trends, regulatory developments and company updates, maintaining industry datasets and producing five market-tracking reports for the team's research coverage.
- Finance & Audit Assistant** — Shandong Qirun Accounting Firm *Jan 2024 – Feb 2024*
- Reviewed accounting vouchers and prepared ledgers and financial statements for 10 SME clients, supporting tax reconciliation and audit procedures under reporting deadlines.

SKILLS & ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Technical: Python (pandas, scikit-learn; project-based), SQL (basic), Excel, Bloomberg Terminal
Risk & Finance: Credit Risk Analysis, Portfolio Risk, Model Robustness, Financial Statement Analysis, Data Analysis
Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Professional working proficiency)
Awards & Leadership: Merit Student Scholarship; 3rd Prize, 10th ERP Sand Table Simulation Competition (Team Leader); Deputy Minister, Elite Accountants Association (NAU).